

game save backups as well. This includes saved files from games on Steam, and Steam's own settings.

Save bandwidth, copy Steam games from a friend

No, we're not talking about piracy here! Games are rather large downloads, many being on the wrong side of 10GB. What's worse is that Steam downloads expanded versions of the game files, so they're even larger than what a game's setup files would be. So if you have a friend / acquaintance who also has the same game on Steam, and has already downloaded it, why not just take the downloaded files from him?

Here's how to go about it:

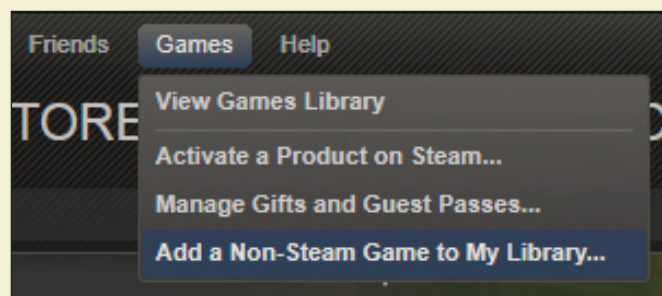
- Start the download process for the game that you are copying from a friend, but pause it immediately after it starts.
- Locate the game install folder under Steam on your friend's computer. In the Steam directory (usually C:\Program Files\Steam\ there's a folder called "steamapps", within which there's the folder "common". Here lie all downloaded Steam games. Each game is in a separate folder, unless it's an expansion.
- Copy the entire folder for your game to the same location on your computer, overwriting whatever little started downloading.
- Resume the download, or,
- Go to the game's properties (right-click > Properties), and under the "LOCAL FILES" tab click on "VERIFY THE INTEGRITY OF GAME CACHE..."

The game will now speed through the download as it won't download files that already exist.

If you can get access to

the non-Steam version of the same game, or even the install disk, you can save a lot of bandwidth. Copy the installed version of the game from a friend's computer to the directory created for it on your computer by Steam. If you have a game setup disk, install the game on your computer first, then copy the installed game folder under Steam, and uninstall the game before proceeding with the above steps. If you use a non-Steam game, you'll need to download more, since many files will be different, and the disk-version might be older.

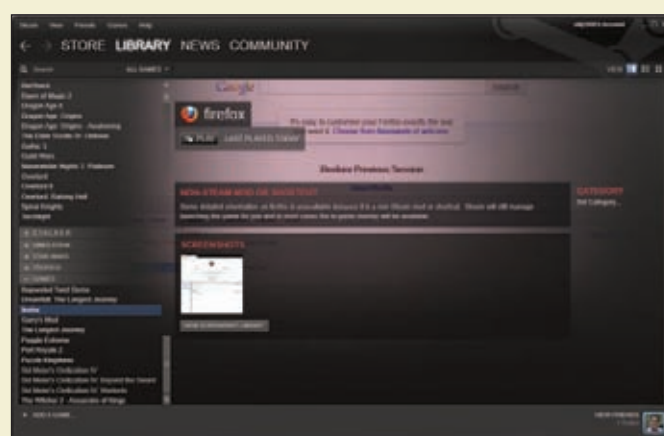
Use the Steam Community In-Game



The option is easily accessible and officially supported

overlay with non-Steam games

Not everyone likes it, but the Steam overlay can be incredibly useful if you use the Steam community features, or would like to access a web site while in the middle of a game without alt-tabbing out.



You'll find several other components to augment your gaming experience at Steam

It's only available for games launched through Steam though. There is, however, an easy way officially supported by Steam that lets you add non-Steam games (or even applica-

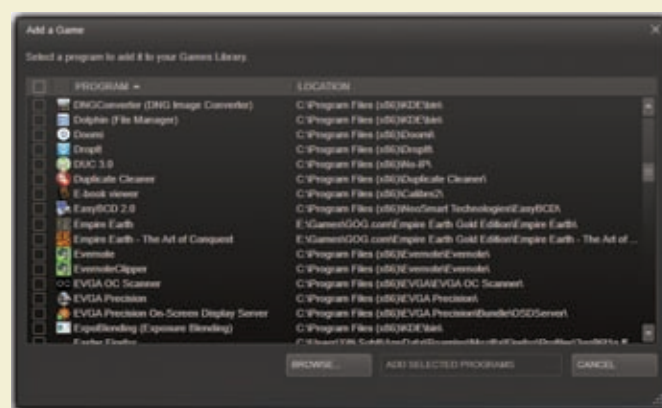
from the list, or speed up the process by clicking on "BROWSE..." and selecting the game exe in the browse dialog.

- Click on "ADD SELECTED PROGRAMS"

The added games / applications will now show up in your Steam interface. They won't support all Steam features, but you'll be able to use the overlay and even take screenshots that can be uploaded to your account. Amaze your friends and open the Steam overlay in Firefox!

Gmail plugins and enhancements

Gmail is one of the most used electronic mail services in the world, and there is no denying its intuitive and customisable interface, its plethora of smart features including its Labs experimental feature section, and its modular nature that allows users to add gadgets, plugins and enhancements to further personalise their Gmail experience. While there are plenty of features that the Gmail and Google Apps team develop themselves for their users, some of which graduate from the Labs section while others make their way directly, there are also thousands of enhancements and plugins made by third party developers, for everything



Steam detects most applications installed on your computer